

Sample Contact Scripts

Disclaimer

These sample scripts focus on “real world” Amateur Practise. These are provided as a guide to assist Amateurs - especially when they are undergoing remote assessments when access to real-world equipment and real-world demonstration with real equipment is impractical.

Candidates for any VK Amateur radio Assessment must be aware of and assessed as competent to the regulated protocols and procedures.

The full protocol is best demonstrated in:

- *Bertrand, R, Wait, P “The Foundation Manual: Your Entry Into Amateur Radio” 3rd Edition, The Wireless Institute of Australia* <https://www.wia.org.au/licenses/foundation/foundationmanual/>
- <https://www.acma.gov.au/amateur-radio-operating-procedures>

Assessment will be based on formal protocols documented.

Note that this document also contains examples of common practises used by Amateurs when making phone (voice) contacts.

HF Contact Script

(a) Always listen to find out if the resource is free. ← Very Important

Is this frequency in Use? This is VK3SIR

Listen for approximately 30 seconds

Is this frequency in Use? This is VK3SIR

Listen for approximately 30 seconds

Hopefully nobody will come back ... so then you can transmit!

The best response if the frequency is in use would be:

This frequency is in use. VK3SIR VK3VM ← Identify yourself and the caller!

DO NOT RESPOND IF SOMEONE SAYS THAT THE FREQUENCY IS IN USE.

Someone may be using the resource that you cannot hear. It is possible that the frequency could be utilised for emergency purposes.

(b) Call CQ

This is the formal procedure that you must be aware of:

CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ VK3SIR VK3SIR VK3SIR CQ CQ CQ
CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ

CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ VK3SIR VK3SIR VK3SIR CQ CQ CQ
CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ

CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ VK3SIR VK3SIR VK3SIR CQ CQ CQ
CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ

This procedure is sometimes seen in use by some operators using digital modes and/or morse code (the mode is termed "CW").

Most (ok... ALL) HAMs using analogue voice (the mode is termed “phone”) truncate “formal” procedure ...

“Practical” real-life procedure example

You will develop your own style. This is an example of a typical style:

CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ This is VK3SIR VICTOR KILO THREE SIERRA INDIA
ROMEO VK3SIR CQ CQ CQ

VK3SIR will then listen for 30 seconds before repeating.

(c) Responding to A CQ call

This assumes that VK3SIR is responding to a call from VK3VM:

VK3VM VK3VM VK3VM VK3SIR VK3SIR VK3SIR ← Formal

VK3VM this is VK3SIR ← Typical real-world

Alternate: VK3SIR ← Repeat your callsign ONCE

(d) Requesting a break-in to an existing conversation OR calling a station that is very busy

(conversation is ongoing)

In the break between stations: VK3SIR ← Repeat your callsign ONCE

(conversation resumes – hopefully a station calls you in with your call presented in a callsign exchange)

***** NEVER USE WORDS LIKE “BREAK” OR “BREAKER” *****

(e) Acknowledging/Calling In a station, with example chatter

You can now be less formal - perhaps dropping some callsign exchanges.

VK3VM VK3SIR Hi My name is Stephen Receiving you 5 by 9 ...
(welcoming statement) VK3VM VK3SIR

VK3SIR VK3VM Hi My name is Steve ... Receiving you 5 by 9+20 ...
(welcoming statement)

We use a system called the **RST (Readability, Strength, Tone)** system to report how we receive a station that we have made contact with.

Readability: This is a subjective measure on a 1 – 5 scale as to how hard it was to understand the conversation (i.e. 5 = perfectly readability, 4 - slight difficulty, 3 - very difficult, 2 - mostly unreadable, 1 - I know you are there but cannot make out what you are saying)

Strength: This is what you read off the signal meter. If it is above 9 we indicate to what degree it is above 9 (i.e. 5 by 9 +20).

Tone: Only added with morse code (CW) and some digital modes. This is a subjective measure (1 – 9) on how “pure” the tone sounds (i.e. 599)

Note: some operators using morse send “5nn”. This is NOT used with voice.

VK3VM VK3SIR Hi Steve What is your QTH? I am located in Oakleigh

VK3SIR VK3VM Hi Stephen My QTH is Hughesdale

Each station is now only required to offer a callsign exchange every 10 mins.

VK3VM VK3SIR VK3VM VK3SIR

(f) Ending a Chat – and no further Operation

VK3VM VK3SIR Thanks for the brief contact. Best wishes and good luck for working more stations. 73 VK3VM VK3SIR

Some stations may add [OVER] at the end of each exchange. This means that they have finished talking.

Stations may add [CLEAR] to the end of their chat. This indicates no more contacts to be accepted/made (i.e. clearing the frequency).

Use of these terms is optional and is not part of documented procedures.

VK3SIR VK3VM Thanks again. 73 VK3SIR VK3VM

Always anticipate someone putting in a callsign at the end – meaning that they want to make contact with you.

(g) QSY to a VHF/UHF Repeater

VK3VM VK3SIR Steve is it possible to QSY to VHF? VK3VM VK3SIR

VK3SIR VK3VM Sure. What Frequency and is it free? VK3SIR VK3VM

VK3VM VK3SIR Please stand by while I check? VK3VM VK3SIR

Change to new frequency and see if it is free – Use the “Section (a) for HF or (i) for Repeaters “Is this frequency Free” Process.

i.e. listen for approximately 30 seconds

VK3VM VK3SIR The VHF Frequency is free. QSY VK3VM VK3SIR

VK3SIR VK3VM Sure. QSY'ing to VHF VK3SIR VK3VM

Then the whole process of listening starts again

Remember – it is THEIR CALL FIRST then YOUR CALL!

VK3VM VK3SIR VK3VM VK3SIR [OVER]

(h) Scripted example of a basic HF Voice QSO

Is this frequency in Use? This is VK3SIR

....

Is this frequency in Use? This is VK3SIR

....

CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ This is VK3SIR VICTOR KILO THREE SIERRA INDIA
ROMEO VK3SIR CQ CQ CQ

....

CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ CQ This is VK3SIR VICTOR KILO THREE SIERRA INDIA
ROMEO VK3SIR CQ CQ CQ

...

VK3SIR this is VK3VM

VK3VM VK3SIR Hi - my name is Stephen My QTH is Oakleigh. I am
receiving you 5/9. What is your name and QTH? How are you receiving me?
VK3VM VK3SIR OVER

VK3SIR VK3VM Hi Stephen. My name is Steve My QTH is Hughesdale. I
am receiving you 5 by 9+20 OVER

End QSO

VK3VM VK3SIR Thanks for the brief contact. Best wishes and good luck for
working more stations. 73 VK3VM VK3SIR CLEAR

VK3SIR VK3VM Thanks for the QSO. 73 VK3SIR VK3VM

End: QSY to VHF

VK3VM VK3SIR Is it possible to QSY to VHF? VK3VM VK3SIR

VK3SIR VK3VM Sure. What frequency and is it free? VK3SIR VK3VM

VK3VM VK3SIR Please stand by while I check? VK3VM VK3SIR

There will be a pause while the check is occurring

VK3VM VK3SIR The VHF Frequency is free. QSY VK3VM VK3SIR

VK3SIR VK3VM Sure. QSY'ing to VHF VK3SIR VK3VM

Repeater Contact Script

(i) Always listen to find out if the resource is free. ⬅ Very Important

Listen for approximately 30 seconds

Repeaters “key up”. If the frequency is in-use you will hear voices through the broken squelch or a “smooth sound”. If no squelch has been set this hissing will stop and a smooth sound will be heard. You should also see an increase in the signal strength received on the Radio’s RF signal meter.

If in doubt ask if the frequency is in use.

Is this frequency in use? This is VK3SIR.

This frequency is in use. VK3VM ⬅ Advise if not free!

Do not communicate further until the resource is free or unless you want to join in. Someone may be using the resource for emergency purposes.

(j) Advise that you are listening

NEVER Call “CQ” on a Repeater ...

You advise/advertise that you are LISTENING.

This is VK3SIR Listening

VK3SIR will then listen for 30 seconds before repeating.

(k) Calling a Station

VK3VM VK3SIR ⬅ Calling for station VK3VM

(l) Responding to A CQ call

VK3VM this is VK3SIR Hi (chatter) ⬅ Typical real-world

(m) Requesting a break-in to an existing conversation OR calling a station that is very busy

(conversation)

In the break: **VK3SIR** ← Repeat your callsign ONCE

**ALWAYS LEAVE BREAKS BETWEEN TRANSMISSIONS
THIS ALLOWS OTHERS TO BREAK IN AND/OR USE THE DEVICE**

Conversation resumes – hopefully a station calls you in with your call presented in a callsign exchange including your callsign.

(n) Acknowledging/calling in a station, with some example chatter

VK3VM VK3SIR Hi my name is Stephen. My QTH is Hughesdale. What is your QTH? VK3VM VK3SIR [OVER]

You can now be less formal and drop some of the callsign exchanges.

Do not give a RST report on Repeaters.

It is ok to state “I have you Readability 5”.

You are not receiving a station’s signal directly – you are receiving signals from a repeater – so there is no point giving a signal strength!

Better - helpful - comments may include “Your modulation is a little soft”.

VK3SIR VK3VM Hi my name is Steve. My QTH is Oakleigh ... (chat) ... [OVER]

Each station is required to give a FULL callsign exchange every 10 minutes.

VK3VM VK3SIR VK3VM VK3SIR [OVER]

VK3SIR VK3VM VK3SIR VK3VM [OVER]

(o) Ending a Chat

Example: If “going” i.e. no further communication sought:

VK3VM VK3SIR Steve ... Thanks for the Chat. 73 VK3VM VK3SIR [CLEAR]

Example: If “leaving” but are still available for further contact:

VK3SIR VK3VM Thanks Stephen. Thanks for the chat ... 73 VK3SIR VK3VM [LISTENING]

(p) Scripted example of a basic Repeater QSO

This is VK3SIR Listening

....

This is VK3SIR Listening

....

VK3SIR VK3VM

VK3VM this is VK3SIR. Hi Stephen. Receiving you loud and clear ... (chat) ...
[OVER]

... (chatter) ...

VK3SIR VK3VM Thanks for the chat. I need to QRT. 73. VK3SIR VK3VM [CLEAR]

VK3VM VK3SIR Thanks again. Same back to you. 73. VK3VM VK3SIR [LISTENING]

Words such as CLEAR, LISTENING and OVER are assistive for other Amateurs, hence why you will often hear Amateurs using these terms in QSO's on repeaters (and on HF).

They are not mandatory and are not specified in the regulations.